

IN THE SENATE

SENATE JOINT MEMORIAL NO. 111

BY RESOURCES AND ENVIRONMENT COMMITTEE

A JOINT MEMORIAL

TO THE SENATE AND THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE UNITED STATES IN CONGRESS ASSEMBLED AND TO THE CONGRESSIONAL DELEGATION REPRESENTING THE STATE OF IDAHO IN THE CONGRESS OF THE UNITED STATES.

We, your Memorialists, the Senate and the House of Representatives of the State of Idaho assembled in the Second Regular Session of the Sixty-eighth Idaho Legislature, do hereby respectfully represent that:

WHEREAS, Idaho's public lands contain unique landscapes, including the timberlands of north Idaho, the canyon rivers of central Idaho, the rangelands that provide livestock forage across southern Idaho, and the habitat that provides hunting and angling opportunities across the state for all Idahoans; and

WHEREAS, public lands, and access to those lands, are a cornerstone of Idaho's identity, and once sold these lands will be lost forever; and

WHEREAS, these lands are more than empty spaces, they offer a level of freedom that defines what it means to be an Idahoan and our way of life; and

WHEREAS, the Second Amendment to the U.S. Constitution preserves and protects U.S. citizens' right to bear arms, and Idahoans frequently exercise this right on public lands within the state as those lands provide the freedom and space to do so; and

WHEREAS, section 23, article I of the Idaho Constitution guarantees the right to hunt, fish, and trap, including by the use of traditional methods, thereby recognizing such right as a valued part of Idaho's heritage that shall forever be preserved for the people and ensuring that the right is protected and preserved through any law, rule, or proclamation; and

WHEREAS, our public lands remain a shared resource, accessible to all Idahoans, not just the wealthy or well-connected; and

WHEREAS, public lands serve as lifelines for Idaho's small businesses, communities, and families; and

WHEREAS, the vital contributions of the grazing, timber, mining, and outdoor recreation industries, which collectively generate more than \$15 billion annually for Idaho's economy, must be safeguarded; and

WHEREAS, selling or transferring these lands would not only jeopardize access and tradition, but also place unsustainable and unpredictable financial burdens on states, local governments, and Idaho's taxpayers; and

WHEREAS, shared stewardship and collaborative land management practices that include local, state, federal, and tribal governments keep public lands in public hands while giving the State of Idaho and local stakeholders more input and decision-making power for critical public land management decisions; and

WHEREAS, removing the threat of mass disposal of public lands will allow decision makers and stakeholders to focus on solutions for improved manage-

1 ment, increased funding for counties with public lands, wildfire response,
2 shared stewardship agreements, and mutually beneficial land exchanges; and

3 WHEREAS, the commitment to keeping public lands public reflects a prin-
4 cipled, conservative approach to stewardship and fiscal responsibility.

5 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the members of the Second Regular
6 Session of the Sixty-eighth Idaho Legislature, the Senate and the House of
7 Representatives concurring therein, that the Legislature commends the Idaho
8 congressional delegation for opposing efforts to sell or transfer Idaho's
9 cherished public lands.

10 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Legislature encourages the Idaho con-
11 gressional delegation to continue fighting for Idahoans by, among other re-
12 lated activities, introducing or cosponsoring legislation such as the Pub-
13 lic Lands in Public Hands Act.

14 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Secretary of the Senate be, and she is
15 hereby authorized and directed to forward a copy of this Memorial to the
16 President of the Senate and the Speaker of the House of Representatives of
17 Congress and to the congressional delegation representing the State of Idaho
18 in the Congress of the United States.